A guide for students finishing 12th grade

Learn What Lasts

A calm, honest guide to choosing skills in the age of AI.

For anyone who has heard that video editing, graphic design or UI/UX will be worthless, and wonders what to do instead.

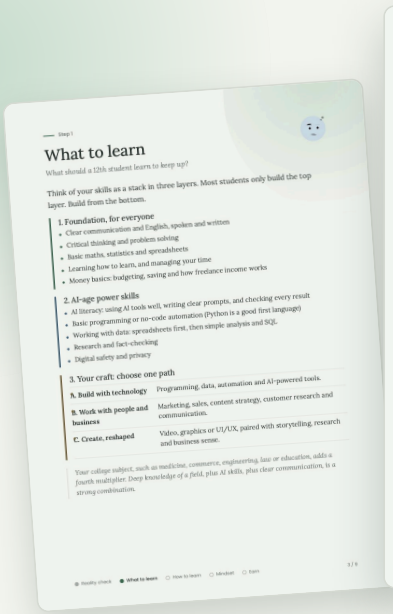
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What to learn

What should a 12th student learns to keep up?

Think of your skills as a stack in three layers. Most students only build the top layer. Build from the bottom.

1. Foundation, for everyone
- Clear communication and English, spoken and written
- Critical thinking and problem solving
- Basic maths, statistics and spreadsheets
- Learning how to learn, and managing your time
- Money basics: budgeting, saving and how freelance income works

2. AI-age power skills
- AI literacy: using AI tools well, writing clear prompts, and checking every result
- Basic programming or no-code automation (Python is a good first language)
- Working with data: spreadsheets first, then simple analysis and SQL
- Research and fact-checking
- Digital safety and privacy

3. Your craft: choose one path

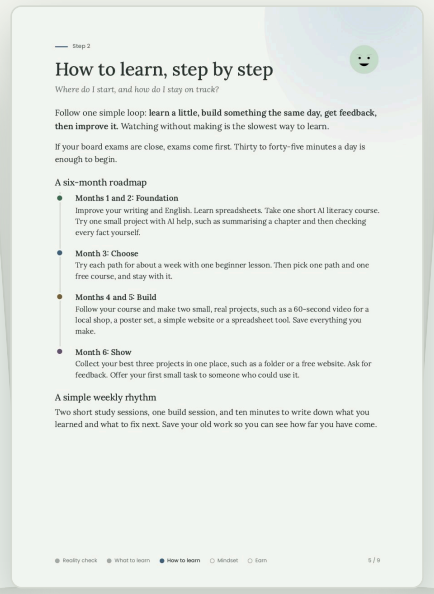
A. Build with technology	Programming, data, automation and AI-powered tools.
B. Work with people and business	Marketing, sales, content strategy, customer research and communication.
C. Create, reshaped	Video, graphics or UI/UX, paired with storytelling, research and business sense.

Your college subject, such as medicine, commerce, engineering, law or education, adds a fourth multiplier. Deep knowledge of a field, plus AI skills, plus clear communication, is a strong combination.

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Your 3-layer skill stack



Step 2

How to learn, step by step

Where do I start, and how do I stay on track?

Follow one simple loop: **learn a little, build something the same day, get feedback, then improve it.** Watching without making is the slowest way to learn.

If your board exams are close, exams come first. Thirty to forty-five minutes a day is enough to begin.

A six-month roadmap

- **Months 1 and 2: Foundation**
  Improve your writing and English. Learn spreadsheets. Take one short AI literacy course. Try one small project with AI help, such as summarising a chapter and then checking every fact yourself.
- **Month 3: Choose**
  Try each path for about a week with one beginner lesson. Then pick one path and one free course, and stay with it.
- **Months 4 and 5: Build**
  Follow your course and make two small, real projects, such as a 60-second video for a local shop, a poster set, a simple website or a spreadsheet tool. Save everything you make.
- **Month 6: Show**
  Collect your best three projects in one place, such as a folder or a free website. Ask for feedback. Offer your first small task to someone who could use it.

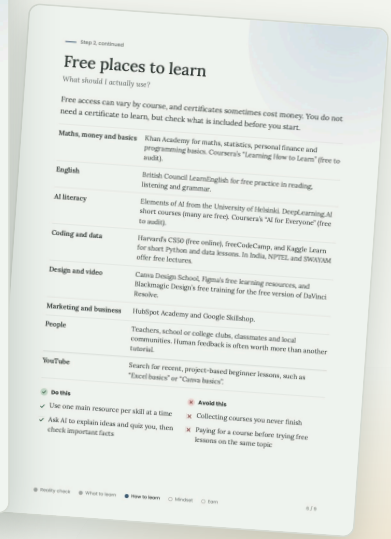
A simple weekly rhythm

Two short study sessions, one build session, and ten minutes to write down what you learned and what to fix next. Save your old work so you can see how far you have come.

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6-month roadmap



Step 2, continued

Free places to learn

What should I actually use?

Free access can vary by course, and certificates sometimes cost money. You do not need a certificate to learn, but check what is included before you start.

Maths, money and basics	Khan Academy for maths, statistics, personal finance and programming basics. Coursera's "Learning How to Learn" (free to audit).
English	British Council LearnEnglish for free practice in reading, listening and grammar.
AI literacy	Elements of AI from the University of Helsinki. DeepLearning.AI short courses (many are free). Coursera's "AI for Everyone" (free to audit).
Coding and data	Harvard's CS50 (free online), freeCodeCamp, and Kaggle Learn for short Python and data lessons. In India, NPTEL and SWAYAM offer free lectures.
Design and video	Canva Design School, Figma's free learning resources, and Blackmagic Design's free training for the free version of DaVinci Resolve.
Marketing and business	HubSpot Academy and Google Skillshop.
People	Teachers, school or college clubs, classmates and local communities. Human feedback is often worth more than another tutorial.
YouTube	Search for recent, project-based beginner lessons, such as "Excel basics" or "Canva basics".

Do this	Avoid this
✓ Use one main resource per skill at a time	✗ Collecting courses you never finish
✓ Ask AI to explain ideas and quiz you, then check important facts	✗ Paying for a course before trying free lessons on the same topic

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Free places to learn

You do not need to predict the future. You need to become someone who can learn what comes next.

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Mymensingh, Bangladesh

You reached the last page.
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